

Rise to the Occasion

"When we least expect it, life sets us a challenge to test our courage and willingness to change."

— PAULO COELHO

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What does it take to meet a challenge?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1 **Rent Party Jazz** · William Miller

HISTORICAL FICTION

2 **Hurricanes: A Force of Nature**

INFORMATIONAL / INTERVIEW

3 **Catch Me If You Can** · Carol Schaffner

PLAY · DRAMA

4 **My Diary from Here to There** · Amada Irma Pérez

AUTOBIOGRAPHICAL FICTION

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C · IB Critical Thinking (5)	p. 11
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Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 3 · Rise to the Occasion · Grade 4 · 23 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

endurance

If you have **endurance**, you can —

- ☐ **A.** finish a task in just a few seconds.
- ☐ **B.** remember many facts at once.
- ☐ **C.** keep doing something for a long time.
- ☐ **D.** change your plans whenever you wish.

Q2 L.4.5 **TRAP**

confront

When you **confront** a problem, you —

- ☐ **A.** face it and deal with it.
- ☐ **B.** run away from it as fast as you can.
- ☐ **C.** pretend that it is not there.
- ☐ **D.** hand it to someone else to solve.

Q3 L.4.6

dauntless

Someone who is **dauntless** —

- ☐ **A.** gets tired very easily.
- ☐ **B.** has no fears and does not give up.
- ☐ **C.** likes to be alone all the time.
- ☐ **D.** forgets things quickly.

Q4 L.4.6

dedication

If someone has **dedication** for something, that person has shown —

- ☐ **A.** a wish to quit soon.
- ☐ **B.** fear of trying it.
- ☐ **C.** a dislike for it.
- ☐ **D.** strong commitment to it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · RENT PARTY JAZZ

Q5 L.4.5

TRAP

auction

At an **auction**, items are —

- ☐ **A.** sold to the person who offers the most money.
- ☐ **B.** given away for free to everyone.
- ☐ **C.** traded for an equal item.
- ☐ **D.** locked away so no one can buy them.

Q6 L.4.4

drifting

The music came **drifting** down the street. If something is **drifting**, it is —

- ☐ **A.** stopping all at once.
- ☐ **B.** getting much louder very fast.
- ☐ **C.** moving slowly without much direction.
- ☐ **D.** sinking straight to the ground.

Q7 L.4.5

TRAP

damp

The morning air felt **damp**. Something that is **damp** is —

- ☐ **A.** completely dry and dusty.
- ☐ **B.** a little wet.
- ☐ **C.** very bright and sunny.
- ☐ **D.** warm and cozy.

Q8 L.4.5

TRAP

spare

Sonny needed money he could **spare**. Something you can **spare** is —

- ☐ **A.** the only one you own.
- ☐ **B.** something you borrowed.
- ☐ **C.** something you lost.
- ☐ **D.** extra, so you do not really need it.

Q9 L.4.4

verses

The **verses** of a song are —

- ☐ **A.** the different sections that usually change throughout the song.
- ☐ **B.** the instruments that play the tune.
- ☐ **C.** the people who sing it together.
- ☐ **D.** the stage where it is performed.

Q10 L.4.4

chorus

The **chorus** of a song is the part that —

- ☐ **A.** is played only at the very end.
- ☐ **B.** no one is allowed to sing.
- ☐ **C.** is repeated after each verse.
- ☐ **D.** changes completely every time.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · RENT PARTY JAZZ (CONTINUED)

Q11 L.4.4

brimming

By the end of the night, the bucket was **brimming** with coins. If something is **brimming**, it is —

- ☐ **A.** almost empty.
- ☐ **B.** full and about to overflow.
- ☐ **C.** cracked down the middle.
- ☐ **D.** half the usual size.

Q12 L.4.4

surge

A hurricane can cause a **surge** of water. If there is a **surge** of water, there is —

- ☐ A. a sudden, large increase in its depth.
- ☐ B. a slow, steady drop in its level.
- ☐ C. a change in its color.
- ☐ D. a layer of ice on top of it.

Q13 L.4.4

debris

After the storm, the streets were covered in **debris**. **Debris** is —

- ☐ A. fresh rain that has just fallen.
- ☐ B. warm, calm air.
- ☐ C. the pieces of something that was broken or destroyed.
- ☐ D. a list of safety rules.

Q14 L.4.4

perished

More than forty people **perished** in the storm. When people **perished**, they —

- ☐ A. were rescued safely.
- ☐ B. moved to a new town.
- ☐ C. hid until it was over.
- ☐ D. died.

Q15 L.4.4

adoringly

The young men looked at Atalanta **adoringly**. If you act **adoringly**, you act with —

- ☐ A. anger and impatience.
- ☐ B. a lot of love and admiration.
- ☐ C. boredom and tiredness.
- ☐ D. fear and worry.

Q16 L.4.5 TRAP

capable

Atalanta said she was **capable** of choosing for herself. If a person is **capable**, he or she —

- ☐ **A.** needs others to do everything.
- ☐ **B.** refuses to try anything new.
- ☐ **C.** is too young to decide.
- ☐ **D.** has the skill or ability to do something.

Q17 L.4.4

spectators

Spectators are people who —

- ☐ **A.** watch an event, such as a sports competition.
- ☐ **B.** compete in the race themselves.
- ☐ **C.** hand out the prizes at the end.
- ☐ **D.** build the track before the race.

Q18 L.4.5 TRAP

disbelief

The king shook his head in **disbelief**. If you feel **disbelief**, you —

- ☐ **A.** are completely sure it is true.
- ☐ **B.** feel proud and pleased.
- ☐ **C.** cannot believe that something is true.
- ☐ **D.** already expected it to happen.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · MY DIARY FROM HERE TO THERE

Q19 L.4.5 TRAP

burst

Amada wrote, "If I don't write this all down I'll **burst**!" Here, to feel like you will **burst** means you —

- ☐ **A.** feel so much emotion that it is hard to hold it in.
- ☐ **B.** pop like a balloon full of air.
- ☐ **C.** fall fast asleep.
- ☐ **D.** feel nothing at all.

Q20 L.4.4

opportunities

The family hoped for new **opportunities**. If you have **opportunities**, you have —

- ☐ **A.** rules you must follow.
- ☐ **B.** problems you must solve.
- ☐ **C.** chores you must finish.
- ☐ **D.** chances to make something good happen.

Q21 L.4.4

immigration

Immigration is the process of —

- ☐ **A.** taking a short vacation.
- ☐ **B.** coming to live in a new country.
- ☐ **C.** visiting a museum for a day.
- ☐ **D.** selling a family's belongings.

Q22 L.4.4

refugees

Refugees are people who —

- ☐ **A.** travel for fun and adventure.
- ☐ **B.** are visiting relatives for the summer.
- ☐ **C.** have to leave their home country because of war or other serious problems.
- ☐ **D.** work for the government of a country.

Q23 L.4.4

amazing

If something is **amazing**, it is —

- ☐ **A.** very surprising and wonderful.
- ☐ **B.** dull and ordinary.
- ☐ **C.** small and unimportant.
- ☐ **D.** hard to understand.



Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 3 · Rise to the Occasion · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3 · RL.4.5 · RL.4.6 · RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3 · RI.4.5 · RI.4.6 · RI.4.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Rent Party Jazz

HISTORICAL FICTION · WILLIAM MILLER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.4.2

What is "Rent Party Jazz" mostly about?

- ☐ A. How to learn to play the trumpet.
- ☐ B. A boy who runs away from his home in New Orleans.
- ☐ C. A boy and his neighbors who throw a party to raise the rent money his family needs.
- ☐ D. A famous singer who moves to Mississippi.

Q2 RL.4.3

Why does Sonny go to work for the coal man each morning before school?

- ☐ A. He and Mama need the extra money the job brings in.
- ☐ B. He wants to learn how to drive the coal wagon.
- ☐ C. He is trying to win a prize at school.
- ☐ D. He does not like to stay in his warm bed.

Q3 RL.4.3

What problem does the family face after Mama loses her job?

- ☐ A. They cannot find the way back to their house.
- ☐ B. Sonny is no longer allowed to go to school.
- ☐ C. The coal man refuses to pay Sonny.
- ☐ D. They may not be able to pay the rent, and the rent man could take their belongings.

Q4 RL.4.3

How does Smilin' Jack help Sonny's family?

- ☐ **A.** He lends them money to pay the rent man.
- ☐ **B.** He suggests a rent party and plays his trumpet at it for free.
- ☐ **C.** He gives Mama a new job at his club.
- ☐ **D.** He buys their house so they can stay.

Q5 RL.4.1

How does a rent party raise money, according to Smilin' Jack?

- ☐ **A.** Guests pay a fee at the door to come inside.
- ☐ **B.** The host sells food and drinks all night long.
- ☐ **C.** Neighbors gather, music plays, and people drop money into a bucket.
- ☐ **D.** The city pays families who hold a party.

Q6 RL.4.6

Why does Smilin' Jack refuse to keep the extra money at the end of the party?

- ☐ **A.** He thinks the family did not earn it.
- ☐ **B.** He is angry that so few people came.
- ☐ **C.** He plans to come back and collect it later.
- ☐ **D.** He says the money belongs to anyone who needs it, and that playing was its own reward.

Q7 RL.4.3

By the end of the night, how does the bucket of money show that the party worked?

- ☐ **A.** It is empty because no one gave anything.
- ☐ **B.** It is brimming with coins, more than enough for the rent.
- ☐ **C.** It holds only a few coins.
- ☐ **D.** It is filled with letters instead of money.

Q8 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "Rent Party Jazz"?

- ☐ **A.** Sonny rides with the coal man each morning and earns ten cents a day before going to school.
- ☐ **B.** Smilin' Jack came from Mississippi and has played his horn all around the country, even up North.
- ☐ **C.** Mama packed fancy fish for a penny a can until she was let go from the canning factory.
- ☐ **D.** People can overcome hard times when a community works together, and helping others is its own reward.

Selection 2 · Hurricanes: A Force of Nature

INFORMATIONAL TEXT AND INTERVIEW · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.4.2

What is "Hurricanes: A Force of Nature" mainly about?

- ☐ **A.** What hurricanes are, how powerful they can be, and how scientists study them.
- ☐ **B.** How to sail a boat across the ocean.
- ☐ **C.** Why summer is warmer than winter.
- ☐ **D.** How to build a house near the beach.

Q10 RI.4.3

According to the text, where and how do hurricanes form?

- ☐ **A.** Over cold mountains, when snow begins to melt.
- ☐ **B.** In deserts, when the sand grows very hot.
- ☐ **C.** Over warm, tropical oceans, where strong winds begin to blow.
- ☐ **D.** High in space, far above the clouds.

Q11 RI.4.3

What does the text say happened when Hurricane Michael hit Florida in 2018?

- ☐ **A.** It passed by with almost no damage.
- ☐ **B.** It destroyed nearly everything in its path, and more than forty people perished.
- ☐ **C.** It turned back out to sea before it landed.
- ☐ **D.** It brought only a light, gentle rain.

Q12 RI.4.3

The text explains that the eyewall is the most dangerous part of a hurricane. Why?

- ☐ **A.** It contains the heaviest rains, the strongest winds, and the thickest clouds.
- ☐ **B.** It is the calm, quiet center of the storm.
- ☐ **C.** It is the part farthest from the ocean.
- ☐ **D.** It is where the storm first begins to weaken.

Q13 RI.4.3

How does a dropsonde help scientists study a hurricane?

- ☐ **A.** It blows the storm away from land.
- ☐ **B.** It takes photographs of the beach below.
- ☐ **C.** As it falls by parachute, it measures wind speed and air pressure and sends the data back to the plane.
- ☐ **D.** It carries people safely out of the storm.

Q14 RI.4.6

In the interview, Shirley Murillo describes flying into the eye of a hurricane as "a once in a lifetime experience" that feels "like you're on a roller coaster." How does hearing this firsthand account help the reader?

- ☐ **A.** It proves that hurricanes are not really dangerous.
- ☐ **B.** It lets the reader understand what the work is truly like from someone who has done it.
- ☐ **C.** It tells the reader how to become a pilot.
- ☐ **D.** It hides the facts about how storms form.

Q15 RI.4.5

This selection uses headings, a chart of hurricane categories, and captioned photographs. How do these text features help the reader?

- ☐ **A.** They turn the article into a made-up story.
- ☐ **B.** They list the price of each instrument.
- ☐ **C.** They hide the most important facts.
- ☐ **D.** They organize the information and help the reader find and understand facts about hurricanes.

Q16 RI.4.8 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea the author wants readers to understand in "Hurricanes: A Force of Nature"?

- ☐ **A.** When Hurricane Michael hit Florida in 2018, it destroyed everything in its path and more than forty people perished.
- ☐ **B.** Hurricanes are powerful, dangerous storms, and scientists work bravely to study and understand them.
- ☐ **C.** The dropsonde is a set of instruments with a parachute that measures wind speed and air pressure as it falls.
- ☐ **D.** During a storm surge the surface of the sea pushes up quickly, and the sea can rise as much as twenty feet.

Selection 3 · Catch Me If You Can

PLAY (DRAMA) · CAROL SCHAFFNER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.4.2

What is the play "Catch Me If You Can" mostly about?

- ☐ **A.** A princess who races for her own freedom instead of being married off.
- ☐ **B.** A king who builds the fastest ship in the land.
- ☐ **C.** A group of messengers who get lost on a journey.
- ☐ **D.** A race to win a golden trophy in a city.

Q18 RL.4.3

Why does King Henry decide to hold a race?

- ☐ **A.** He wants to find the fastest horse in the land.
- ☐ **B.** He hopes to win a prize for himself.
- ☐ **C.** He has decided the winner of the race may marry his daughter, Atalanta.
- ☐ **D.** He wants to teach the young men how to run.

Q19 RL.4.3

What does Atalanta really want to do with her life?

- ☐ **A.** Marry the fastest runner in the kingdom.
- ☐ **B.** Go out and see the world and make her own choices.
- ☐ **C.** Become queen and rule the land.
- ☐ **D.** Stay home and never leave the palace.

Q20 RL.4.3

After Young John nearly ties Atalanta in the race, what does he choose to do?

- ☐ **A.** He demands to marry her at once.
- ☐ **B.** He challenges her to race again.
- ☐ **C.** He asks the king for a different prize.
- ☐ **D.** He refuses to claim her as a prize and asks only to get to know her.

Q21 RL.4.5

"Catch Me If You Can" is written as a play. Which feature shows that it is a play rather than a story?

- ☐ **A.** It has a cast of characters and lines of dialogue with stage directions in parentheses.
- ☐ **B.** It is divided into chapters with page numbers.
- ☐ **C.** It uses headings, charts, and captions.
- ☐ **D.** It is written as a list of facts.

Q22 RL.4.6

What is the role of the Narrator in the play?

- ☐ **A.** The Narrator runs in the race against Atalanta.
- ☐ **B.** The Narrator is the king's chief advisor.
- ☐ **C.** The Narrator tells the audience about the action and helps move the story along.
- ☐ **D.** The Narrator only announces the winner at the end.

Q23 RL.4.3

How do Atalanta and Young John each spend their time at the very end of the play?

- ☐ A. They get married and stay in the palace.
- ☐ B. They set off to travel and see the world, each visiting a different place.
- ☐ C. They take over the kingdom together.
- ☐ D. They never speak to each other again.

Q24 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "Catch Me If You Can"?

- ☐ A. Atalanta can run as fast as the wind, and she is also bright, clever, and able to fix almost anything.
- ☐ B. The race takes place once upon a time in a kingdom, and messengers are sent out to announce it.
- ☐ C. Young John went out for a run each evening until he could run as fast as the wind.
- ☐ D. A person should be free to make their own choices, and respect beats being treated as a prize.

Selection 4 · My Diary from Here to There

AUTOBIOGRAPHICAL FICTION · AMADA IRMA PÉREZ · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.4.2

What is "My Diary from Here to There" mostly about?

- ☐ A. A girl named Amada whose family moves from Mexico to the United States, told through her diary.
- ☐ B. A class trip to a museum in Los Angeles.
- ☐ C. A girl who learns to play in a band.
- ☐ D. A family that opens a restaurant in Juarez.

Q26 RL.4.3

Why must Amada's family leave their home in Juarez?

- ☐ A. They want to live closer to the beach.
- ☐ B. Their house is too small for the family.
- ☐ C. Papa lost his job, and there is no work for him there.
- ☐ D. They are going on a long vacation.

Q27 RL.4.3

What does Papa tell Amada to help her feel brave about the move?

- ☐ A. He tells her she is stronger than she thinks, and that he made it through a big change too.
- ☐ B. He promises they will move back home very soon.
- ☐ C. He tells her not to worry about anything ever.
- ☐ D. He says she will not have to go to a new school.

Q28 RL.4.3

What does Amada keep to help her remember her best friend, Michi?

- ☐ A. A photograph of their school.
- ☐ B. A heart-shaped stone they exchanged, and she writes letters to her.
- ☐ C. A drawing of the border.
- ☐ D. A song they wrote together.

Q29 RL.4.6

The story is told as Amada's diary entries, using the word "I." How does this point of view help the reader?

- ☐ A. It keeps Amada's feelings a secret from the reader.
- ☐ B. It tells the story from Papa's point of view.
- ☐ C. It lets the reader share Amada's private thoughts, fears, and hopes as she lives through the move.
- ☐ D. It makes the events feel like they never really happened.

Q30 RL.4.3

What does Amada come to understand about herself by the end of her diary?

- ☐ A. That she would rather have stayed behind alone.
- ☐ B. That she does not need her family anymore.
- ☐ C. That she will never make new friends.
- ☐ D. That she is strong wherever she is — in Mexico, in the States, anywhere.

Q31 RL.4.3

How does crossing the border in Tijuana make Amada feel, and what helps her get through it?

- ☐ A. It feels easy, and she crosses all by herself.
- ☐ B. It feels calm, and a guard carries her across.
- ☐ C. It feels crowded and scary, but the family holds hands and stays together the whole way.
- ☐ D. It feels boring, so she falls asleep.

Q32 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "My Diary from Here to There"?

- ☐ A. Amada has five brothers named Mario, Victor, Héctor, Raúl, and Sergio.
- ☐ B. The family stops in Mexicali, where the relatives welcome them with a feast of tamales and hot chocolate.
- ☐ C. Papa was born in Arizona and moved back to Mexico with his family when he was six years old.
- ☐ D. With the love of family and a record of one's memories, a person finds the strength to face a hard change and start a new life.



Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 3 · Rise to the Occasion · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about what it takes to meet a challenge. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Responsibility DOK 3

In "**Rent Party Jazz**," Sonny's family faces a hard challenge. Show the PROBLEM they face, then explain HOW the community and Smilin' Jack help them rise to the occasion.

MEETING THE CHALLENGE · RENT PARTY JAZZ

THE PROBLEM

WHAT THEY DO

HOW IT ENDS

Smilin' Jack says the money "belongs to anybody who needs it." What does this show about helping others? Use the word *responsibility* in your answer.

Q2

Causation

DOK 3

In "**Hurricanes: A Force of Nature**," one thing leads to another. Trace the CHAIN of cause and effect that turns warm ocean water into a dangerous storm, then explain why scientists study hurricanes.

CAUSE AND EFFECT · HURRICANES

CAUSE 1 · WARM OCEAN

what does warm tropical water start?

CAUSE 2 · STRONG WINDS

what do the winds create?

EFFECT · ON LAND

what happens when it hits the coast?

Why do scientists fly into hurricanes to gather data? How does this help people who live near the coast?

Q3

Perspective

DOK 3

In "**Catch Me If You Can**," Atalanta and her father, King Henry, see her future very differently. Show what EACH of them wants, then explain how Atalanta rises to the occasion.

TWO POINTS OF VIEW · CATCH ME IF YOU CAN

WHAT THE KING WANTS

WHAT ATALANTA WANTS

Young John ties Atalanta but will not claim her as a prize. What does his choice show about respect? Explain.

Q4

Connection

DOK 3

In "**My Diary from Here to There**," Amada is afraid of a big change but slowly grows stronger. Compare how she feels at the START of her journey with how she feels by the END.

FROM FEAR TO STRENGTH · MY DIARY FROM HERE TO THERE

AMADA AT THE START

AMADA BY THE END

How do Amada's family and her memories of home help her find the strength to meet this challenge? Explain.

Essential Question: What does it take to meet a challenge? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What challenge is faced here, and what does it take to meet it?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What challenge is faced here, and what does it take to meet it?

MY BIG IDEA



Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 3 · Rise to the Occasion · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Long Climb

Maya had wanted to reach the top of Eagle Hill all summer. The trail was long and steep, and the first time she tried, she gave up halfway and walked back down. That night she felt upset with herself. The next morning she decided to try again, but this time she made a plan. She would walk slowly and rest whenever she felt tired. She filled a bottle with water and packed a small snack. As she climbed, her legs began to ache, and once she almost turned around. Instead, she stopped, took a deep breath, and kept going one step at a time. Near the top, the path grew rocky, but Maya did not quit. When she finally reached the very top, she could see the whole town spread out below her like a tiny map. She felt proud, not only of the view, but of herself for not giving up. Maya learned that meeting a hard challenge takes patience, a good plan, and the courage to keep trying.

170 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1 RIT 200 Lexile 500L Key Detail

What did Maya want to do all summer?

- ☐ A. Reach the top of Eagle Hill.
- ☐ B. Learn to swim in a lake.
- ☐ C. Win a running race.
- ☐ D. Build a tree house.

Q2 RIT 202 Lexile 520L Cause & Effect

Why did Maya feel upset with herself after her first try?

- ☐ A. She forgot her water bottle.
- ☐ B. She gave up halfway and walked back down.
- ☐ C. She fell and hurt her knee.
- ☐ D. She climbed the wrong hill.

Q3 RIT 203 Lexile 530L Key Detail

What plan did Maya make for her second try?

- ☐ **A.** To run as fast as she could the whole way.
- ☐ **B.** To ask a friend to carry her pack.
- ☐ **C.** To walk slowly, rest when tired, and bring water and a snack.
- ☐ **D.** To climb only when it was raining.

Q4 RIT 205 Lexile 550L Inference

When the path grew rocky near the top but Maya "did not quit," this shows that she —

- ☐ **A.** was no longer interested in the view.
- ☐ **B.** had forgotten why she was climbing.
- ☐ **C.** wanted someone else to finish for her.
- ☐ **D.** had learned to keep going even when something is hard.

Q5 RIT 206 Lexile 560L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Long Climb"?

- ☐ **A.** Meeting a hard challenge takes patience, a plan, and the courage to keep trying.
- ☐ **B.** Maya packed a water bottle and a small snack before her second try up the hill.
- ☐ **C.** From the very top of Eagle Hill, Maya could see the whole town spread out below her.
- ☐ **D.** The first time Maya tried the trail, she gave up halfway and walked back down.

Passage 2 · The Storm Spotters

Long before there were satellites in space, people had no way to know that a big storm was coming. A storm could strike a town with almost no warning. Today, weather scientists work hard to keep people safe. They use many tools to track storms as they form and grow. Tall towers send out invisible signals called radar that bounce off raindrops and show where rain is falling. Floating buoys in the ocean measure the height of the waves and the speed of the wind. Some scientists even fly small planes straight into a storm to gather facts that no machine on the ground can collect. All of this information is sent to a weather center, where experts study it and decide whether a town is in danger. If a dangerous storm is on the way, they send out a warning so families can prepare or move to a safer place. Thanks to these storm spotters and their tools, fewer people are caught by surprise when a powerful storm arrives.

170 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 Lexile 560L Key Detail

Long ago, why could a storm strike a town with almost no warning?

- ☐ **A.** Storms moved much faster in the past.
- ☐ **B.** There were no satellites or tools to track storms.
- ☐ **C.** People did not care about the weather.
- ☐ **D.** Towns were built too close to the sea.

Q7 RIT 208 Lexile 580L Key Detail

What do floating buoys in the ocean measure?

- ☐ **A.** The color of the water.
- ☐ **B.** The number of fish below.
- ☐ **C.** The height of the waves and the speed of the wind.
- ☐ **D.** The depth of the sand on the beach.

Q8 RIT 209 Lexile 590L Cause & Effect

Why do experts at the weather center study the information they receive?

- ☐ **A.** To find the best place to go fishing.
- ☐ **B.** To decide what to name each storm.
- ☐ **C.** To measure how deep the ocean is.
- ☐ **D.** To decide whether a town is in danger and needs a warning.

Q9 RIT 210 Lexile 600L Inference

Why is it brave for scientists to fly small planes straight into a storm?

- ☐ **A.** The storm is dangerous, but the facts they gather can help keep people safe.
- ☐ **B.** The planes can only fly at night.
- ☐ **C.** They are trying to make the storm stop.
- ☐ **D.** They want to take pictures for fun.

Q10 RIT 211 Lexile 620L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Storm Spotters"?

- ☐ **A.** Tall towers send out radar signals that bounce off raindrops to show where rain is falling.
- ☐ **B.** Weather scientists use many tools to track storms and warn people so they stay safe.
- ☐ **C.** Some scientists fly small planes straight into a storm to gather facts from inside it.
- ☐ **D.** Floating buoys in the ocean measure the height of the waves and the speed of the wind.

Passage 3 · Wilma Rudolph Runs

When Wilma Rudolph was a little girl, almost no one believed she would ever walk well, let alone run. As a child she became very sick and lost the use of one of her legs. For years she had to wear a heavy brace just to stand. Doctors said she might never walk without it. But Wilma was determined. Every day her family helped her exercise her weak leg, rubbing it and moving it for hours. Slowly, with great effort, Wilma began to walk. Then she began to run. By the time she was a teenager, she was one of the fastest runners at her school. She practiced harder than anyone, refusing to let her early illness hold her back. In 1960, Wilma Rudolph traveled to the Olympic Games and won three gold medals in running races. The girl who once could not walk had become one of the fastest women in the world. Her story reminds us that with hard work, help from others, and a will that does not quit, people can overcome enormous challenges.

Q11 RIT 211 Lexile 620L Key Detail

What happened to Wilma Rudolph when she was a child?

- ☐ A. She moved to a new country.
- ☐ B. She won her first race at school.
- ☐ C. She became very sick and lost the use of one of her legs.
- ☐ D. She learned to swim before she could walk.

Q12 RIT 212 Lexile 640L Cause & Effect

How did Wilma slowly begin to walk again?

- ☐ A. Her family helped her exercise her weak leg every day for hours.
- ☐ B. A doctor gave her a new pair of shoes.
- ☐ C. She waited until the brace fell off on its own.
- ☐ D. She stopped trying and rested for years.

Q13 RIT 213 Lexile 660L Key Detail

What did Wilma Rudolph do at the Olympic Games in 1960?

- ☐ A. She carried the Olympic torch.
- ☐ B. She won three gold medals in running races.
- ☐ C. She coached the other runners.
- ☐ D. She watched the races from the stands.

Q14 RIT 215 Lexile 680L Vocabulary

The passage says Wilma "was determined." In this sentence, **determined** means —

- ☐ A. tired and ready to rest.
- ☐ B. firmly decided to do something and unwilling to give up.
- ☐ C. unsure about what to do next.
- ☐ D. afraid of trying anything new.

Q15 RIT 216 Lexile 700L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Wilma Rudolph Runs"?

- ☐ A. As a child, Wilma had to wear a heavy brace just to be able to stand.
- ☐ B. Every day Wilma's family rubbed and moved her weak leg for hours to help her.
- ☐ C. At the 1960 Olympic Games, Wilma Rudolph won three gold medals in running races.
- ☐ D. With hard work, help, and a will that does not quit, people can overcome huge challenges.

Passage 4 · The New Student

On his first day at Lincoln School, Diego felt his heart pound. He had just moved from a town far away, and everything here was strange. The hallways were crowded with students he did not know, and he could not find his classroom. Worst of all, he worried that no one would want to be his friend. At lunch he sat alone, staring at his tray. Then a girl named Priya sat down across from him. "You're new, right?" she asked with a smile. "I was new last year. It was hard at first, but it gets better." She introduced him to her friends, and soon Diego was laughing along with the group. By the end of the week, he knew his way around the school and had a place to sit at lunch. Diego realized that meeting the challenge of a new school did not mean facing it completely alone. Sometimes the bravest thing is to accept a kind hand, and the kindest thing is to offer one. A single friendly act had turned a scary day into the start of something good.

184 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16

RIT 216

Lexile 700L

Key Detail

Why was everything at Lincoln School strange to Diego?

- ☐ **A.** He had just moved from a town far away.
- ☐ **B.** He had been sick for a long time.
- ☐ **C.** He was much older than the other students.
- ☐ **D.** He had never been to school before.

Q17

RIT 217

Lexile 720L

Cause & Effect

Why did Diego sit alone at lunch on his first day?

- ☐ **A.** He wanted to be by himself.
- ☐ **B.** He did not know anyone and worried no one would want to be his friend.
- ☐ **C.** The other tables were all full.
- ☐ **D.** He had forgotten his lunch at home.

Q18

RIT 218

Lexile 740L

Key Detail

How did Priya help Diego feel better?

- ☐ **A.** She showed him how to find his bus.
- ☐ **B.** She gave him part of her lunch.
- ☐ **C.** She sat with him, told him it gets better, and introduced him to her friends.
- ☐ **D.** She helped him with his homework.

Q19

RIT 219

Lexile 770L

Inference

Why does the passage say "the bravest thing is to accept a kind hand"?

- ☐ **A.** Because Diego should have stayed home instead.
- ☐ **B.** Because making friends is against the rules.
- ☐ **C.** Because Priya was the only kind student in the school.
- ☐ **D.** Because it can take courage to let others help you when you feel alone.

Q20

RIT 220

Lexile 800L

Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The New Student"?

- ☐ **A.** On his first day, Diego could not find his classroom in the crowded hallways.
- ☐ **B.** Priya sat down across from Diego and told him she had been new last year.
- ☐ **C.** By the end of the week, Diego knew his way around the school.
- ☐ **D.** A hard challenge like a new school can be met with courage and the kindness of others.